



Managing Engagement for Outcomes

Week 6 • Day 2 • Stakeholder Alignment & Negotiation

TPM Academy



Day 2 Objectives

- Apply the **4 engagement principles**: early, deliberate, match-form-to-power, bidirectional
- Pick **cadence + format + length** per quadrant
- Build "right now" asks across **decisions / information / action**
- Diagnose your **engagement anti-patterns** and design counter-measures
- Identify the **5 most consequential asks** for Friday's negotiation



Today's Shape

Clock	Block	Outcome
09:00 – 09:15	Opening	Pin SEP §1 grid + RACI on the wall
09:15 – 10:30	Block 1 + Activity 1	Engagement style calibration
10:45 – 12:00	Block 2 + Activity 2	Recurring engagement plan
13:00 – 14:15	Block 3 + Activity 3	"Right now" asks
14:30 – 16:00	Block 4 + Activity 4 + Wrap	Anti-patterns + AI cross-check

Block 1 — Engagement Principles

Four rules + style by quadrant



The 4 Engagement Principles

Principle	Plain English
Engage early	Surprise = anger. Surface concerns before decisions.
Engage deliberately	One channel per stakeholder.
Match form to power	High-power gets crisp writing; high-interest gets conversation.
Bidirectional asks	Every engagement names what they need from us AND what we need from them.

(3) and (4) are the differentiators. Most TPMs do (1) and (2) by quarter 2 in role.



Style by Quadrant

Quadrant	Cadence	Format	Length
HP × HI	Weekly / bi-weekly	Brief + 30-min sync	1 page; focused agenda
HP × LI	Monthly / trigger	Crisp written	< 250 words
LP × HI	Bi-weekly	Email digest; group thread	5 bullets
LP × LI	Quarterly / launch	Newsletter	Short

Starting points. Adjust per stakeholder personality.

Activity 1 — Engagement Calibration

Triads • 35 minutes

8 stakeholder profiles. Place on grid; pick cadence/format/length.

- 10 min: place all 8 on the grid
- 15 min: pick cadence + format + length
- 10 min: disagree on 1–2; document why



10 + 15 + 10

Block 2 — Recurring Engagement Plan

Per stakeholder: cadence, format, channel, asks



Engagement Plan Template

```
### <name role="">
**Quadrant:** ...

<p><strong>Cadence:</strong> weekly / bi-weekly / monthly / trigger
<strong>Format:</strong> memo / email / sync / standup mention
<strong>Length:</strong> < N words / < N min</p>
<p><strong>What they need from us (recurring):</strong> ...
<strong>What we need from them (recurring):</strong> ...</p>
<p><strong>What they need from us right now:</strong> ...
<strong>What we need from them right now:</strong> ...</p>
<p><strong>Channel of choice:</strong> email / Slack / sync / Confluence
<strong>Backup channel:</strong> ...</p>
</name>
```

```
<strong>Stakeholder-specific notes:</strong> ...
```



Time Allocation Sanity Check

- **Most time** → high-power × high-interest
- **Crispest writing** → high-power × low-interest
- **Group channels** → low-power × high-interest
- **Light touch** → low-power × low-interest

Most rookie TPMs over-invest in low-power × high-interest. They're easy to engage; they ask for time.

Activity 2 — Recurring Plan

Triads • 40 minutes

- 5 min: sort by quadrant
- 10 min: HP × HI detailed plans
- 10 min: HP × LI crisp plans
- 5 min: LP × HI group plans
- 5 min: LP × LI lightweight plans
- 5 min: time allocation sanity check



5 + 10 + 10 + 5 + 5 + 5

Block 3 — "Right Now" Asks

Decisions / Information / Action — both directions

The 3 Asks Categories

Category	Examples
Decisions	Confirm scope; sign off on architecture; approve SLO targets
Information	Answer a question; share a doc; introduce someone
Action	Add a story to backlog; schedule a review; make a call

Reciprocal asks: what will *they* ask of *you*? Predict; don't be surprised.



Conflict Surfacing

Are any asks across stakeholders **in tension with each other?**

- Asking architect to defer + asking eng director to approve launch date
- Asking security for a fast review + asking compliance for a thorough audit
- Asking CS for customer feedback + asking sales not to surface it yet

Surfacing conflict early is the senior-author signal. Buried conflict ships as escalation.

Activity 3 — "Right Now" Asks

Triads • 40 minutes

- 20 min: 3–5 asks per stakeholder (mix of categories)
- 10 min: predict reciprocal asks
- 5 min: flag conflicts
- 5 min: pick the 5 most consequential



20 + 10 + 5 + 5

Block 4 — Anti-Patterns + AI Cross-Check

Diagnose tendencies; design counter-measures

The 6 Engagement Anti-Patterns

Anti-pattern	Counter-measure
Channel sprawl	One channel of record per stakeholder
Rolling silence	Calendar each cadence as recurring
Surprise reveal	Engage early; pre-share
Asymmetric asks	Build "what we offer" into each engagement
Veto avoidance	Trigger-based engagement from watch list
Email avalanche	Match length to audience

AI Cross-Check

```
Role: Senior PM reviewing a junior TPM's engagement plan.  
Context: <sep §1="" +="" §2="" stakeholder="" list="" and="" engagement="" plans="">  
Task: Identify the top 3 engagement risks:  
1. A stakeholder likely under-served by the plan  
2. A stakeholder likely over-served (TPM wasting attention)  
3. A specific anti-pattern the plan is exposed to  
Constraints:  
- Be specific  
- Suggest a concrete adjustment  
Format: 3 findings – Risk / Why / Adjustment.</sep>
```

Activity 4 — Anti-Patterns + AI

Triads • 45 minutes • Wrap

- 10 min: score self on 6 anti-patterns (H/M/L)
- 15 min: design counter-measures for top 2–3
- 15 min: document in §2
- 5 min: AI prompt + provenance



10 + 15 + 15 + 5 · 15-min wrap



Day 2 Wrap

What we built

- Recurring engagement plan per stakeholder
- "Right now" asks (decisions/info/action)
- Reciprocal asks predicted
- 5 most consequential asks for Friday
- Anti-pattern counter-measures
- SEP §2 drafted

What opens tomorrow

- **Communicating technical trade-offs**
- One-page brief for non-technical execs
- Translation layer: TCD/TMD trade-offs → business

Bring to Day 3: SEP §§1–2 + your TCD §5 trade-offs. Tomorrow we

translate one for an exec.

Questions & Reflection

Which stakeholder will you stop hiding from after this week?